

Open Finance operations, out of the box

A distribution partnership between MiddleLeap and Ozone

Ozone connects the market to Open Finance. This partnership lets the market run it.

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- **Companion records:** ADR 0026 (accepted commercial positioning) · ADR 0027 (this partnership, proposed) · `multitenant-platform-blueprint.md` · `ozone-si-enablement-pack.md` · `ozone-channel-nebras-cbuue-note.md`

1. Executive summary

Ozone has already won the hard part of UAE Open Finance: the connectivity and trust layer. The API Hub authorises every consent, issues every token, and mediates every call between a TPP and an LFI; Ozone Connect gets each licensed institution certified and on the network. That is the control plane, and it is Ozone's.

Connectivity is necessary but not sufficient. A bank or insurer can pass CBUAE certification and still be unable to *operate* Open Finance the next morning: the API-Hub fees arrive unverified, the 16 login-only LFI reports go unread, a customer-care call about a consent has no tool behind it, an unauthorised-payment refund has no SLA-governed workflow, and a liability event is discovered only on the monthly invoice. This is the **execution layer** — the back office that turns *certified* into *operationally live* — and today the mandated long tail has no way to build it.

MiddleLeap has built that layer. The **Open Finance Back Office (OFBO)** is a bank-neutral, multi-tenant operations platform that runs an institution's Open Finance in both roles it must play — LFI for inbound consented traffic, and TPP-of-record for the fintechs it hosts. It is demonstrable today on a live, seeded demo, built vendor-neutrally against a nine-port integration model, and multi-tenant by construction.

The proposal is simple. MiddleLeap builds and maintains the product; Ozone distributes it, under Ozone's or the Al Tareq brand, through the system-integrator (SI) channel Ozone already runs; SIs deliver each institution's integration. Ozone's offer to the market moves from *connectivity* to *connectivity plus operations* — a more complete "Open Finance in a box" for exactly the buyers who cannot or will not build custom.

MiddleLeap builds · Ozone distributes · SIs deliver.

This document sets out the market, the gap, the product, why the fit is natural for Ozone, the distribution and commercial model (mechanics only — figures are for us to negotiate), the go-to-market motion, the proof, and the joint path to production.

2. The market and the moment

CBUAE Circular **C 03/2025** makes Open Finance mandatory. It obligates **every licensed bank and every insurance company and broker** — on the order of **50 banks and 60+ insurers/brokers**, plus exchange houses — against a fixed release calendar and a fixed per-event liability schedule.

- **The deadlines are close and non-negotiable:** Extended Data and Insurance Quotes (R4+, Apr 2026), Corporate suite (R5, Sep 2026), Insurance data-sharing onboarding (2026-Q3), and CAAP migration (2026-Q4). *(An industry-wide compliance deadline of 16 Sep 2026 is widely cited; treat as directional pending CBUAE confirmation.)*
- **The liability is real and per-event:** the scheme's Limitation of Liability Model attaches a specific amount to each operational failure — from AED 200 for an SLA miss, through AED 500 for a consent-state failure, to AED 5,000 for a breaking-change mishandling and AED 10,000 for a fraud-prevention failure — under Nebras's own AED 5,000,000 per-claim cap.
- **The capacity does not exist across the tail.** Most mandated institutions have neither the engineering bench nor the runway to build a compliant back office in the time available.

This is the textbook condition for a shared, out-of-the-box capability: *compliance is not optional, and building it is infeasible for most*. Ozone has solved this shape of problem before — **CAAP**, where the tail could not build FAPI-grade authentication, so the scheme hosted it centrally and extended it segment by segment. **Operations is the next CAAP.**

3. The gap Ozone does not yet fill

The cleanest way to see the opportunity is the UAE model's own division of labour:

API Hub = control plane. LFI = execution layer.

Ozone owns the control plane and the certification path onto it. What it does not yet give an institution is the execution layer — the recurring, un-glamorous operational work that keeps a participant compliant and commercially whole *after go-live*:

OPERATIONAL OBLIGATION	WHAT IT TAKES, DAY TO DAY	CONSEQUENCE OF NOT HAVING IT
Fee & settlement reconciliation	Three-way match: API-Hub billing ↔ the bank's own logs ↔ downstream fintech billing, with break detection and dispute filing	Pay Nebras invoices blind; over-billing undetected; a prerequisite for payment go-live is missing
Consent & dispute operations	Search a PSU's consents across all TPPs; revoke (fraud path four-eyes-gated) with <5s scheme acknowledgment; investigate unauthorised payments; next-business-day refunds	Care and fraud calls have no tool behind them; refund SLAs breach
Mandatory reporting	Generate CBUAE-format reports; ingest the 16 login-only LFI reports that have no API , with integrity hashes and missed-cadence alerts	Reports late or malformed; cadence discipline fails
Liability exposure	Monitor per-event exposure against the scheme's schedule <i>before</i> it crystallises	Liability discovered on the monthly invoice, not managed
Governance, audit, lineage	Four-eyes on sensitive actions; INSERT-only audit; BCBS 239 column-level lineage; 24-month/5-year retention	Fails examination; no defensible record
TPP-of-record billing	Register hosted fintechs, reconcile before invoicing, track margin	The bank's own Open Finance revenue book is unmanaged

None of this is connectivity. All of it is mandatory. This is the layer the tail cannot build — and the layer this partnership sells.

4. The solution — OFBO

What it is. OFBO is the internal control room for an institution's Open Finance business — the screens and services staff use to *check the money, help customers, and watch the platform*. It is built for the institution that wears two hats at once: an **LFI** holding PSU accounts and serving inbound consented TPP traffic, and a **TPP-of-record** consuming other LFIs' APIs on behalf of the fintechs it hosts — a billable, reconciled counterparty. Every reconciliation line and liability event carries that role dimension.

What it does — six capability areas, in business terms:

- 1. Reconciliation console** — daily three-way reconciliation, break detection with configurable thresholds, an SLA-clocked investigation workflow, one-click scheme dispute creation, monthly Finance sign-off, and TPP-of-record margin tracking.
- 2. Customer care (consent & dispute operations)** — sub-second PSU consent search across the full CBUAE consent lifecycle and all TPPs; single/bulk/fraud revocation with <5s scheme acknowledgment; unauthorised-payment investigation with four-eyes-gated next-business-day refunds; CBUAE inquiry-bundle generation.
- 3. Analytics & insight** — one executive dashboard (commercial and programme views), plus operations, compliance, risk and finance consoles; a proactive liability-event monitor; consent anomaly detection; cross-fintech aggregation the individual fintechs cannot see.
- 4. A regulated substrate (built first, not retrofitted)** — RBAC scope enforcement, four-eyes approvals, INSERT-only high-sensitivity audit, mandatory MFA, OpenTelemetry tracing, BCBS 239 lineage at write time, 5-year retention, PII redaction, and region-parameterised deployment.

5. **Integration enablers** — the nine port integrations to the institution's estate (see below).
6. **Scheme interaction & TPP billing** — a consuming-TPP registry with Trust Framework Directory sync, monthly TPP invoicing on a strict *reconcile-before-invoice* pipeline, and scheme fraud-incident and service-desk case tracking.

Why it is productisable — three architectural facts that de-risk distribution:

- **Vendor-neutral by construction (the port model).** Everything institution-specific is a *port* — a named integration point with a defined contract. The core never references a vendor; the adopting institution maps each port to its estate in configuration.

PORT	WHAT THE INSTITUTION SUPPLIES
P1	Customer-care surface (portal-resident, or CRM such as Salesforce)
P2	Enterprise IdP (OIDC/SAML2) + mandatory MFA
P3	ITSM & alerting (ServiceNow, Jira SM, ...)
P4	Core-banking read (Finacle, Flexcube, T24, ...) — reconciliation inputs
P5	Enterprise APM, bridged off the OpenTelemetry stream
P6	Scheme egress gateway — all Nebras-bound traffic, FAPI 2.0 mTLS; no direct egress
P7	Data catalogue / BCBS 239 lineage sink (Collibra, Purview, ...)
P8	Onboarding handover (optional)
P9	Financial system / ERP — TPP counterparty registration + invoicing (SAP, Oracle, ...)

- **Adapter swap, not rewrite.** Every port has two implementations behind one interface — a simulator (demo) and an enterprise adapter (bank adoption) — selected by configuration, never by branching in application code. Porting to an institution is *adapter replacement plus a Bank Profile*, and an enterprise adapter must pass exactly the tests the simulator passes. That is a clean, testable acceptance gate for every deployment — and the natural unit of SI delivery.
- **Multi-tenant from day one at the data layer.** Every regulated table carries a tenant key under forced row-level security; the platform is serverless and region-parameterised. Running many institutions from one platform is a hardening-and-provisioning programme, not a re-design (see §10 and the multi-tenant blueprint for the honest state of this).

It is real today. A live, seeded demo runs the whole story end to end — a single fraud incident traced across five consoles (a dispute in Care, a break in Finance, a signal in Risk, a four-eyes refund in Approvals, a scheme case in Operations) — with a fault-injection switch that triggers a fee-variance break or a liability signal on demand, on synthetic data only.

5. Why this is a natural fit for Ozone

Ozone is not being asked to enter a new business. It is being offered a value-adding layer that sits exactly where its existing offer stops, sold through the motion it already runs:

- **Ozone already powers the hub.** OFBO consumes the hub's surfaces through the single P6 egress and, for refunds and health checks, through Ozone Connect. It never re-implements the gateway, the

resource server, or CAAP. It is strictly complementary — the operations layer on top of the connectivity Ozone provides.

- **Ozone already runs the distribution muscle.** Ozone's published partner program spans a ladder — Referrer, Reseller, Premium Reseller — up to *delivering a completely dedicated, partner-branded Open Finance infrastructure with visibility across tenants*, backed by white-labeling, dedicated partner managers, sales enablement, and co-marketing. OFBO drops into that program as a value-adding module, not a new SKU to invent.
- **Ozone already has the SIs.** The channel that integrates Ozone's platform at each institution is the same channel that maps OFBO's nine ports and swaps its enterprise adapters. No new delivery network is required.
- **It completes the story to the buyer who won't build.** For the mandated long tail and new entrants, "connect me" is half the ask; "let me run it" is the other half. A combined connectivity-plus-operations offer is materially harder for a competitor to match and materially easier for an institution to say yes to.

6. The distribution model — full reseller / OEM white-label

The lead model is **full reseller / OEM white-label**: Ozone takes OFBO to market as part of its own offer, under its own or the AI Tareq brand, and owns the customer relationship end to end.

Roles are clean and non-overlapping:

PARTY	ROLE	OWNS
MiddleLeap	OEM product vendor	Product build, roadmap, maintenance, releases, L3 support, multi-tenant platform operations
Ozone	OEM reseller / distributor	The customer relationship, brand, commercial terms, billing, first-line support, channel enablement
SIs	Delivery	Per-institution port mapping, enterprise-adapter integration, Bank Profile configuration, go-live, certification support

Product packaging — two tiers on one codebase. OFBO already separates along a compliance-vs-assurance line, and that line is the packaging boundary:

- **Console tier** — the operational basics: consent operations and care, participant-side dispute case management, mandatory reporting with integrity hashes, the STR/AML trail, and the regulated audit/retention posture. **Non-adversarial; freely white-labellable and resellable** by Ozone (e.g. an "AI Tareq Operations Console"). This is the volume tier for the long tail.
- **Assurance tier** — three-way reconciliation, fee/invoice verification, the liability monitor and forecast, scheme-SLA observability, and TPP-of-record margin. This tier's whole value is that it *checks the scheme's homework* — it reconciles against Nebras invoices and measures the hub's own acknowledgment times.

Independence safeguard (please read — it protects the revenue, it does not shrink it). Because the assurance tier audits the platform an institution connects through, its commercial credibility depends on its being seen to operate *independently* of the platform provider. An examiner will reasonably object if the party that builds the hub also operates the tool that audits the hub. This does **not** stop Ozone distributing the assurance tier. It means we structure it as **independently operated, Ozone-distributed** — MiddleLeap retains operational independence of the reconciliation and liability functions under contract (a documented separation of duties, data-processing stance, and audit posture), while Ozone carries it to market and shares in the revenue. The independence *is* the product; keeping it intact is what makes the assurance tier un-commoditisable and durable. See ADR 0027 for the mechanism.

Tenancy tiers (how institutions are hosted — detail in the multi-tenant blueprint):

- **Pooled, shared-schema with row-level security** — the near-zero-marginal-cost default for the long tail and Tier-2.
- **Dedicated cell / database** — for Tier-1 or high-sensitivity carriers, or where a regulator requires a hard boundary.
- **Region cells** — to satisfy per-institution data residency.

7. The commercial framework (mechanics, not figures)

Per your steer, this sets out *how the money works* and leaves every number to negotiation. The structure follows how ISV-plus-channel-plus-SI partnerships are built, and how regulated "as-a-service" offerings are priced.

Three revenue streams:

1. **Recurring subscription (per tenant).** An OEM licence MiddleLeap charges Ozone per hosted institution (or per tier band); Ozone sets its own end-customer price and keeps the margin. This is the annuity, and it scales with the mandate.
2. **One-time onboarding / integration (SI-led).** Each institution's port mapping, adapter swap, Bank Profile and go-live is delivery revenue for the SI, with a defined MiddleLeap role for product-side enablement and L3.
3. **Optional premium modules.** The assurance tier, the insurer module, and advanced analytics price as add-ons on top of the console-tier base.

The money flow: the institution pays **Ozone**; Ozone pays **MiddleLeap** the OEM subscription (per-tenant or tiered); the **SI** bills integration and may take a share of recurring for managed-service relationships. MiddleLeap additionally retains L3 and platform-operations responsibility, funded within the OEM fee.

Pricing philosophy — anchor to value, not to cost. Two anchors make the buyer's ROI concrete without a single feature-by-feature line item:

- **Liability exposure avoided.** OFBO turns operating discipline (revokes acknowledged in <5s, breaks resolved in-SLA, compliant notifications) into an auditable "AED liability avoided" figure, computed per institution. This is the number that lands hardest with a Tier-2 or insurer buyer — it reframes the subscription as insurance against a schedule they are already exposed to.

- **Build-versus-buy avoided.** The cost, time, and execution risk of building this in-house against the R4+/R5 deadlines — for an institution that has no bench to build it — is the second anchor.

Structuring norms we will draw on (the basis, not the number):

- Ozone's own partner ladder (Referrer / Reseller / Premium Reseller / dedicated infrastructure) gives a ready commercial spine to graft onto.
- Regulated "compliance/operations-as-a-service" offerings standardise on **tiered per-institution subscriptions** — and offerings with three tiers materially outperform single-price ones, because they map to the real spread of long-tail / Tier-2 / Tier-1 buyers.
- The clean ISV-builds / channel-distributes / SI-integrates split keeps each party earning in the currency it is best at: product annuity, channel margin, and project services respectively.

IP and rights. MiddleLeap retains all product IP. Ozone receives distribution rights, with exclusivity, territory and term to be agreed (a natural first cut: UAE-market, time-boxed, renewing on performance). The assurance-tier independence safeguard is a term of the agreement, not an afterthought.

8. Go-to-market motion

The motion runs through Ozone and its SIs, and it reuses assets that already exist:

1. **Top of funnel — credibility and try-before-you-buy.** The open **Open Finance Data Sandbox** (an OpenFinance-OS Commons contribution — synthetic UAE personas across banking, insurance and ATM, spec-accurate to Standards v2.1, reachable five ways including npm, PyPI and an MCP server) lets a prospect's engineers touch coherent Open Finance data in minutes, and demonstrates deep command of the Standards. The live OFBO demo lets a solutions engineer run a "here is what running your Open Finance looks like" walkthrough on the first call.
2. **Qualification.** The Integration Readiness Wizard turns the port model into a self-assessment — a prospect gets a port-by-port readiness score and a generated Bank Profile skeleton, which is also the SI's scoping input.
3. **Pilot.** A scoped SI-led pilot stands the console tier up for the institution on synthetic data, then swaps the first ports.
4. **Rollout.** White-label deployment, tenant provisioning, and (where wanted) the assurance-tier add-on.

Segment sequencing mirrors the CAAP extension calendar (banking → insurance → exchange houses), so the rollout rides a cadence the market already understands. A sensible lighthouse is **2–3 insurers or exchange houses** on the 2026 onboarding calendar — small enough to move fast, visible enough to reference.

9. Proof and credibility

Everything in this proposal is demonstrable, and we are deliberate about what is proven versus what is planned:

- **The Data Sandbox** — open (MIT code, CCO data), vendor-neutral, ~38 synthetic personas across three domains, hardened by thousands of automated tests, pinned to a single Standards SHA. It is *not* a sales

asset — and that is precisely why it earns trust: it never names or ranks an institution, and it demonstrates competence rather than asserting it. It is arm's-length evidence of the same command of Standards v2.1 an institution is buying in a back office.

- **The live OFBO demo** — the full six-capability story on seeded synthetic data, with the fault-injection switch that makes regulatory behaviour visible on a call.
- **A repeatable build method** — a governed discovery → delivery harness with human sign-off at every merge, INSERT-only audit and lineage as a definition-of-done, and a documented data-risk-control map.
- **Track record** — MiddleLeap's team has led UAE firsts: a first bank certification and first live licensed-TPP transactions.

Honest maturity, stated plainly. OFBO is **demo-proven, not production-proven**, and runs on **synthetic data only** today. Its data plane is multi-tenant; the multi-tenant *control plane* (per-request tenant identity, re-scoped aggregation, per-tenant certificate custody, operator certifications) is **designed and backlogged, not yet built**. Production hardening and the first tenant provisioning are the joint work of this partnership — not a claim we are making. Our brand runs on numbers we can count; we will not represent readiness we have not earned.

10. Roadmap to production, and what we need from Ozone

The path from "demo-live" to "first paying tenant in production" is a sequenced, human-gated programme — detailed in `multitenant-platform-blueprint.md`. In brief:

1. **Isolation hardening** — re-scope the cross-institution aggregation path and move tenant identity onto every request, behind a permanent cross-tenant isolation CI gate. (*Non-negotiable before a second tenant exists.*)
2. **Tenant provisioning** — self-service stand-up of a new institution with its own configuration.
3. **Per-tenant identity, egress and certificate custody** — each institution on its own FAPI 2.0 scheme certificate through its own P6 path.
4. **Operator assurance** — SOC 2 / ISO 27001 for the hosting operator (Ozone already holds ISO/IEC 27001), the C 14/2021 outsourcing posture, per-tenant transparency and kill-switch.
5. **Insurer module and the liability-avoided ROI screen.**

What we ask of Ozone to start:

- **Channel commitment** — a decision to carry OFBO as a value-adding layer in the partner program.
- **A lighthouse customer** — one or two willing institutions from the 2026 onboarding calendar.
- **SI enablement** — a first delivery partner briefed on the port-mapping playbook (pack attached).
- **Scheme positioning support** — a joint conversation with Nebras/CBUAE on the outsourcing and independence posture (framing attached).

11. Risks and how we manage them

RISK	MANAGEMENT
Channel concentration on one distributor	Multi-tier packaging keeps direct and scheme motions open in parallel; term-boxed exclusivity
Assurance-tier independence challenged by an examiner	Independence safeguard (§6): independently operated, Ozone-distributed; documented separation of duties
Operator liability under a shared platform	The operator is a PDPL Processor (Art 8 joint liability) under CBUAE Outsourcing C 14/2021; per-tenant outsourcing agreements, onshore system-of-record, back-to-back liability allocation
Data residency across tenants	Region cells; residency as a per-tenant property, not one global parameter
Production hardening not yet done	Framed as joint partnership work with a gated plan; nothing represented as production-ready before it is
"Ozone/Nebras could build it"	It exists now (demo URL); the assurance tier is structurally un-buildable by the platform operator; the mandate window rewards speed over a fresh build

12. Next steps

1. **A 45-minute working demo** — the Alpha Bank walkthrough: consent revoke → dispute → report → refund → scheme case, with a fault injected live.
2. **A commercial working session** — packaging, tiers, and the OEM/rev-share mechanics against your partner-program spine.
3. **A scoped lighthouse pilot** — 2–3 institutions on the 2026 calendar, one SI briefed.
4. **A joint scheme conversation** — Nebras/CBUAE on the outsourcing and independence posture.

Let's put a working session in the calendar.

Appendix A — Module-to-tier assignment (from ADR 0026)

MODULE	TIER	RATIONALE
Consent operations + care surface	Console	Non-adversarial; raises scheme compliance
Dispute case management (participant side)	Console	Mirrors the hub service; reduces support load
Mandatory reporting + integrity hashes	Console	Scheme wants cadence discipline
STR/AML trail	Console	Regulatory basics; no scheme conflict
Three-way reconciliation + break workflow	Assurance	Disputes scheme invoices
Fee/invoice verification, billing disputes	Assurance	Adversarial to the scheme by design
Liability monitor + predictive forecast	Assurance	Tracks exposure against the scheme
Scheme-SLA observability	Assurance	Measures the hub itself
TPP-of-record pass-through billing + margin	Assurance	The institution's own commercial book

Appendix B — Tenant segments (from the multi-tenant blueprint)

SEGMENT	ISOLATION	PACKAGING
Tier-2 banks	Pooled RLS; dedicated cell on request	Console + optional assurance
Tier-1/2 insurers & brokers	Pooled; dedicated cell for large carriers	Console + insurer module
Exchange houses	Pooled	Console tier
Long-tail fintechs / new entrants	Pooled	Console tier
Tier-1 banks	Dedicated DB / their own estate	Enterprise deploy (later, upmarket)

Appendix C — Glossary (terms used exactly)

- **LFI** — Licensed Financial Institution (bank/insurer/broker/exchange house) implementing Ozone Connect and serving consented TPP traffic.
- **TPP** — Third-Party Provider; consumes APIs via the API Hub only, never directly.
- **API Hub** — Nebras-operated, Ozone-powered central platform: authorization server, TPP-facing resource server, gateway, and consent store. The control plane.
- **Ozone Connect** — the LFI-side connection standard an institution implements; not a "resource server".
- **Nebras / AI Tareq** — the operator / the consumer-facing trust-framework brand.
- **CAAP** — Centralized Authentication and Authorization Platform; the scheme-hosted precedent for "capability the tail cannot build".
- **TPP-of-record** — an LFI acting as a TPP-as-a-Service for the fintechs it hosts; a billable, reconciled counterparty.

All demo data is synthetic; no real PSU data exists anywhere in the system. Commercials in this document are indicative and subject to negotiation. Contact: [owner to insert].